Granton

R&D TIP

How to write an R&D hypothesis

5 parts of a hypothesis that holds up

Swipe →

01

Start with the uncertainty

Describe what you do not know and cannot work out in advance. If a competent professional could simply look up the answer, it is not uncertain.

02

State a testable prediction

Write what you expect to happen if your approach works. It must be a statement an experiment can prove wrong.

03

Define how you will test it

Describe the experiment.

- What you will change
- What you will hold constant
- What you will measure

04

Say what success looks like

Write down the measurable result that would support or reject the hypothesis before you run the test.

05

Record the evaluation

After the test, record what happened, what you concluded and what you did next, including failures. Dated records made at the time are the easiest to rely on.

Pass it on

Share it with a founder or developer documenting experimental work.